



Genius Traveler 355 Laser

A unique notebook mouse

When we unpacked the Genius Traveler 355 Laser, it looked like any other notebook mouse—small and pretty, but with a blue light where the scroll wheel would normally have been. We discovered the middle button is no



longer just a clickable scroll wheel. It has an optical scanner that tracks the motion of your finger over it, and lets you scroll in any axis. It still functions as a button. This is a good, unique feature: you'll no longer have a roller getting spoilt after a few

months of use.

The mouse supports resolutions of 800 and 1600 dpi. The only way to switch between them is to press all the three buttons together—we tried this, and found no indication of what dpi we were switching to or using, on-screen or in the drivers!

Left-handed users should have no problem using this one. The mouse is small and lacks curves and ergonomic shape, though. Still, overall, the comfort level is OK.

The mouse tracks well, and thanks to its lightness, it slides well on most surfaces. The optical scroll we talked about tracks vertical movement well, but horizontal movement seems a little sluggish.

Build quality is pretty OK, but the cable is definitely a concern. It is really thin—almost half the thickness of that of a typical desktop mouse.

The software CD installs the drivers by itself and the software for the mouse. Installed were some 15-odd processes, which ate up 60 to 65 MB of memory! Other than the standard tasks like changing sensitivity and scroll speed, setting the action for the middle click is about the biggest thing you can do with the drivers.

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★☆
Build Quality	★★★★☆
Value for Money	★★★★☆
Overall	★★★★★

You're better off using the default Windows drivers.

The one good thing we could agree on was the mouse itself—performance was more than satisfactory. It is really small and pretty light, which makes it suitable for any laptop user.

The price tag of Rs 1,800 is a wee bit high—wired notebook mice would be cheaper. For the additional price, you get unique features like the optical scroller, and pretty good performance. Buy this mouse if it fits your budget, but keep away from the drivers!

Specifications

USB interface; resolutions: 800 / 1600 dpi; Vista compatible

Contact: KYE Systems India Ltd
Phone: 011-41580611
E-mail: sales_india@geniusnet.com.tw
Web site: www.geniusnet.com
Price: Rs 1,899

Logitech diNovo Edge

An expensive keyboard for the style-conscious

The diNovo Edge is Logitech's costliest offering from its keyboard line-up. It is thin and sleek—just around 1 cm tall.

The frame is sturdy; it has a layer of Plexiglas on top, which gives it a nice, glossy finish. The downside, however, is that you're bound to get scratches and fingerprints on it. It won't go down too well with users with sweaty hands either. But there's no denying it looks great. There's a brushed metal panel to complement the glossy Plexiglas.

With the short key travel, this feels like a laptop keyboard. A circular touchpad acts as a mouse. Moving your finger around the edges lets you scroll vertically and horizontally. The touchpad is pretty small, though, and is a little cumbersome to use. It can be turned off if you'd like.

There is no numeric keypad, and many of the keys have been made smaller to accommodate them in the small, sleek form factor. The touch slider for volume control is a good addition. Indicators light up when you press some of the keys. Pressing the Function key [FN], for example, lights up the multimedia buttons, which are coupled with the function keys ([F1] through [F12]). There are buttons for putting the PC into



standby, for opening the default media player, and for muting system sound.

The wireless Bluetooth connection worked perfectly fine with no glitches from 20 ft or so. Also, we should mention that you get a chic charging dock to go with the looks of the keyboard itself.

Sleek and elegant it may be, but the feel of the keys really lets the diNovo Edge down. The high price tag of Rs 15,995 is another major downside. Other keyboards from Logitech with more features—such

as the G11 and the G15—are priced at half that much or less. Those are a lot bulkier, and are meant for gaming. The only saving grace for the diNovo Edge is its looks.

Specifications

Dimensions: 11 x 410 x 210 mm; weight: 940 gm; Bluetooth 2.0; inbuilt 950 mA Li-ion battery

Contact: Logitech India
Phone: 022-26571160
E-mail: kavita_nath@logitech.com
Web site: www.logitech.com
Price: Rs 15,995

RATINGS

Performance	★★★★★
Features	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★